

Outstanding Achievements

The world became a smaller place after Alcock and Brown's 1919 transatlantic flight. During the 1920s long-distance flights attracted huge public attention, inspiring newspapers and governments to sponsor ever more ambitious journeys. Many intrepid pilots died, but those who survived clocked up remarkable feats of endurance. Piston-engined aircraft were now powerful and reliable, but the most impressive trips were achieved by vast, luxurious airships.

▽ Avro Avian 1926

Origin UK

Engine 90 hp ADC Cirrus air-cooled 4-cylinder in-line

Top speed 105 mph (169 km/h)

The Avian was a sound late 1920s tourer popular for record flights. In 1927 Bert Hinkler flew solo from Croydon, UK to Darwin, Australia in 15½ days and in 1928 Amelia Earhart crossed the US and back in one.



△ Douglas World Cruiser 1923

Origin USA

Engine 423 hp Liberty L-12 water-cooled V12

Top speed 103 mph (166 km/h)

Five World Cruisers were built for the US Army Air Service, based on a torpedo bomber. In April to Sept 1924 "Chicago" and "New Orleans" flew 27,533 miles (44,310 km) around the world in 371 hours, 11 minutes flying time, averaging 70 mph (113 km/h).



▷ Junkers W.33 Bremen 1926

Origin Germany

Engine 310 hp Junkers L.5 water-cooled 6-cylinder in-line

Top speed 120 mph (193 km/h)

An advanced all-metal cantilever monocoque freighter, "Bremen" made the first east-west heavier-than-air nonstop Atlantic crossing in 1928. Another W.33 set an endurance record of 52 hours and 22 minutes in 1927.



△ Ryan NYP Spirit of St. Louis 1927

Origin USA

Engine 223 hp Wright R-790 Whirlwind J-5C air-cooled 9-cylinder radial

Top speed 133 mph (214 km/h)

Based on Ryan's M-2 mailplane, the NYP was designed and built in 60 days by Donald A. Hall. Charles Lindbergh made the first nonstop solo Atlantic crossing and first New York to Paris flight in this aircraft in 1927.



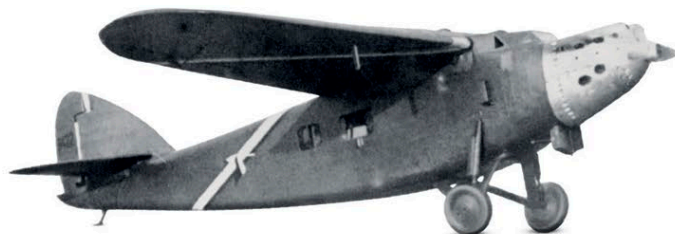
△ Bernard 191GR Oiseau Canari 1928

Origin France

Engine 600 hp Hispano-Suiza 12 Lb water-cooled V12

Top speed 134 mph (216 km/h)

Three record breakers were based on the enclosed-cockpit 190. This one made the first French North Atlantic crossing, piloted by Jean Assolant, René Lefèvre, Armand Lotti, and a stowaway, in June 1929.



△ Fairey Long-range Monoplane 1928

Origin UK

Engine 570 hp Napier Lion X1a water-cooled V12

Top speed 110 mph (177 km/h)

Built for the RAF to set nonstop distance records, one, with a bed for the copilot, made the first nonstop flight from Britain to India in 1929. The second flew a record 5,410 miles (8,707 km) to southwest Africa in 1933.

